by a rather similar pattern drawn out over nearly six decades – cooperation descending into conflict and climaxing in the threat of full-scale war.

Tibet Again

India and China have gone through a cooperation to conflict phase in Tibet as well. Immediately after the 1962 war, Delhi hardened its approach to Tibetan affairs. Gradually, though, it softened its stand and avoided provoking Beijing unduly. By the early 2000s, it had recognized almost fully Tibet's integration in China. However, in 2006, India's Tibet policy changed in response to China's policy on Arunachal Pradesh. Conflict over Tibet is a possibility especially in the post–Dalai Lama future.

Towards cooperation

After the 1962 war, Delhi's involvement with Tibet was initially focused on dealing with the exiles in India and occasionally poking Beijing in the eye. In 1963, Delhi set up the Special Frontier Force, which consisted of Tibetan refugees in India. The force was designed to be used in high-altitude warfare in the western and eastern sectors in the event of hostilities with China. It fought for India in the Bangladesh war of 1971, at Siachen in the 1990s, and was used in Galwan in 2020 (with one highly publicized fatality).[105] Beyond this, also in 1963, Delhi helped the Dalai Lama write a constitution for Tibet.[106] Garver claims that in addition in the 1960s India set up a communications station in Odisha to maintain contact with Tibetan insurgents, coordinated with the CIA on the insurgency in the province, and organized former Indian Air Force personnel to air-drop supplies to resistance fighters.[107] In December 1965, after Beijing's belligerent statements and actions during the India–Pakistan war, Delhi for the first time supported a UN resolution on Tibet. By 1966, it seemed to be on the verge of recognizing the Tibetan government-in-exile, but Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri's death at the summit in Tashkent stopped further